

Waiting on the World to Change -- John Mayer

From *Continuum* (2006). About 88 BPM, est.

Instrument: Sire V7 2nd Gen 5-string fretless, flatwound. Run Passive. GP-5 only.

A deep, muted soul pocket. As far as I know, Pino Palladino played on much of *Continuum*, and his signature is a short, thumpy, flatwound note that sits behind the beat.

The Sire's flatwounds give that thump for real. No EQ trickery needed to fake it.

Passive, not Active. Pino's sound is a vintage passive thump. The passive tone knob rolled back gets there naturally. Active's extra headroom and hi-fi top pull away from it.

Neck pickup soloed or strongly favored. Passive tone knob around 35%. Fingers over the neck, with light palm-muting for short notes.

Fretless mwah should stay subtle. Plucking over the neck keeps it down. An occasional slide into a note is a nice, vocal soul touch. Watch intonation on the sustained roots.

AMP: Classic Bass (Ampeg SVT) + CAB: Apg115 IR (User IR 1)

A B-15 with a dark top is the classic soul thump, the studio amp behind decades of this sound. With real flats, it only needs a gentle top trim, not a hard cut.

Module chain

NR -- Gate, always on.

THRE: 10.

Low. Fretless notes and slides need to decay naturally.

PRE -- COMP (Ross), always on.

Sustain: 38, VOL: 58.

Even, thumpy notes. It also evens out level jumps from fretless slides.

DST -- off. No grit.

AMP -- Classic Bass, always on.

Gain: 20, Bass: 58, Middle: 52, MidFreq: 220Hz, Treble: 35, VOL: 66.

Dark and thumpy. Treble 35 is higher than a roundwound version would need, because the flats already roll off the top.

CAB -- User IR 1 (Apg115), always on.

VOL: 60.

EQ -- Bass EQ 2, always on.

50Hz: 0, 120Hz: +2, 400Hz: +1, 800Hz: 0, 4.5kHz: -3, VOL: 52.

120Hz thump and 400Hz wood. 800Hz stays flat so the fretless mwah isn't accented. -3 at 4.5kHz is a gentle trim. The flats do the rest.

MOD -- off. No chorus. Fretless plus chorus is a different, more Egan-like sound. This one stays dry soul.

DLY -- off.

RVB -- Room, on CTL.

Mix: 10, Decay: 25, Trail: on.

A tiny room for the choruses.

CTL footswitch

On CTL: RVB (Room).

- **CTL off** -- Verses. A dead, deep, muted soul pocket. This is the resting state the patch loads into.
- **CTL on** -- Choruses. A small room so the thump blooms slightly.

Engage at the choruses. Mostly this patch lives in CTL off.